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13TH FEBRUARY 2026

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compilation for
Government Exams like
RBI, SEBI, NABARD, PFRDA, NHB
and Bank PO

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Memory check

12th February 2026

Q1. The new series of GDP, CPI and IIP are being introduced mainly to improve which of the following aspects of economic indicators?

- A. Political transparency and electoral reforms
- B. Relevance, accuracy and international comparability
- C. Reduction in fiscal deficit
- D. Expansion of tax collection
- E. Increase in foreign exchange reserves

Q2. What are the proposed new base years for GDP and IIP under the comprehensive revision by MoSPI?

- A. 2017–18 for both GDP and IIP
- B. 2020–21 for both GDP and IIP
- C. 2022–23 for both GDP and IIP
- D. 2024–25 for both GDP and IIP
- E. 2019–20 for GDP and 2022–23 for IIP

Q3. Under White Revolution 2.0, what is the key target set for milk procurement in India over the next five years?

- A. Increase by 25% to reach 800 lakh kg/day
- B. Increase by 40% to reach 900 lakh kg/day
- C. Increase by 50% to reach 1,007 lakh kg/day by 2028–29
- D. Double procurement to reach 1,500 lakh kg/day
- E. Maintain current levels with improved storage

Q4. The Unified Lending Interface (ULI), developed under RBI Innovation Hub, currently has how many lenders onboarded?

- A. 53
- B. 72
- C. 89
- D. 101
- E. 141

Q5. Under the interim India–US trade deal, India secured zero-duty access to a US import market worth approximately:

- A. \$10 billion
- B. \$25 billion
- C. \$46 billion
- D. \$160 billion
- E. \$3.4 billion

**Answer key at the
end of the file**

RBI, Banking and Economy

RBI unveils major push to strengthen Co-op Banks: MoS

RBI Reforms for Cooperative Banks (2026)

Overall Objective

- **RBI**, in consultation with the **Government of India**, introduced reforms to strengthen the **cooperative banking ecosystem**.
- Focus areas:
 - **Financial health**
 - **Governance**
 - **Credit flow**
 - **Digital inclusion**
- Information shared by **MoS Finance Pankaj Chaudhary** in **Rajya Sabha**.

Priority Sector Lending (PSL) Boost

- Loans given by banks to **National Cooperative Development Corporation (NCDC)** for on-lending to cooperatives now classified as **Priority Sector Lending**.
- **Effective date: January 19, 2026**.
- Applies to banks **excluding**:
 - **RRBs**
 - **Urban Cooperative Banks**
 - **Small Finance Banks**
 - **Local Area Banks**
- Expected to:
 - Increase **credit availability**
 - Support **cooperative societies & rural institutions**

Strengthening Urban Cooperative Banks (UCBs)

- **New branch openings allowed** for UCBs.
- **Housing loan limit increased**:
 - From **10% → 25%** of total loans & advances.
- Aim: Expand **lending capacity** and **urban outreach**.

Governance Reforms

- Amendments to the **Banking Regulation Act**.
- **Tenure of cooperative bank directors** extended:
 - From **8 years → 10 years**.
- Intended to improve **stability and management continuity**.

Digital Inclusion Initiatives

- **AePS onboarding costs reduced** → encourages digital transactions.
- Creation of new shared technology support institutions:
 - **NUCFDC**: Umbrella IT & operational support body for UCBs.
 - **Sahakar Sarthi**: Shared Services Entity for Rural Cooperative Banks.

Depositor Protection

- All cooperative banks continue under **DICGC insurance cover**.
- Protection up to **₹5 lakh per depositor**.
- Helps build **trust & depositor confidence**.

Learn Along:

About RBI

Headquarters: Mumbai

Established: 1 April 1935

Governor: Sanjay Malhotra

Retail inflation at 2.75% in new Consumer Price Index with 2024 as the base year

Latest Inflation Data

- MoSPI released a **new CPI series** with **2024 as base year** (earlier: 2012).
- **Retail inflation (CPI)** for **January 2026** stood at **2.75%**.
- **First release** under the new base year → **no direct historical comparison** yet.

Expansion in Coverage

- **Total items covered:** increased to **358** (earlier **299**).
 - **Goods:** **308** (earlier **259**)
 - **Services:** **50** (earlier **40**)
- Reflects **updated consumption patterns** from **HCES 2023–24**.
- Shows structural change in **economy, consumption behaviour, and household spending**.

Wider Data Collection Network

- **Rural markets covered:** **1,465** (earlier **1,181**)
- **Urban markets covered:** **1,395** (earlier **1,114**)
- **New addition:** data from **12 online marketplaces**
- Ensures **more representative and granular inflation measurement**.

More Detailed Classification

- Groups expanded from **6 to 12 broad categories**.
- Provides **granular data** for better policy analysis.
- **Weights revised** based on **HCES 2023–24 consumption trends**.

Major Changes in Weightage

Food & Beverages

- Weight reduced to **36.75%** (earlier **45.86%**).
- Lower food weight may make **headline inflation less volatile**.

Housing & Utilities

- Expanded to include **water, electricity, gas, fuels**.
- Combined weight increased to **17.67%** (earlier **10.07%** for housing alone).

Paan, Tobacco & Intoxicants

- Weight increased to **2.99%** (earlier **2.38%**).

Clothing & Footwear

- Weight reduced to **2.38%** (earlier **6.53%**).

Newly Emphasised Categories (with Weights)

- **Furnishings & household maintenance:** **4.47%**
- **Health:** **6.1%**
- **Transport:** **8.8%**
- **Information & communication:** **3.61%**
- **Recreation, sports & culture:** **1.52%**
- **Education services:** **3.33%**
- **Restaurants & accommodation:** **3.35%**
- **Personal care & miscellaneous:** **5.04%**

Policy Significance

- Basket aligned with **latest expenditure patterns** → **more realistic inflation signals**.
- Helps in **better calibration of monetary and fiscal policy**.
- Reflects **changing structure of Indian economy** over the last decade.

Historical Data Adjustment

- Index values available from **January 2025** under new method.
- **Linking factor** provided to estimate CPI back to **2013**.

- However, **year-on-year inflation comparison** currently possible only for **January 2026**.

India–US trade deal seen lifting surplus by \$45 bn, exports could top \$100 bn annually: Report

Overall Economic Impact

- **India–US trade relationship** set for a major **reset** after new bilateral trade agreement.
- **India's annual trade surplus** with the US projected to rise by **\$45 billion**.
- **Export potential** could exceed **\$100 billion per year**.
- Net impact estimated to:
 - Add **~1.1% to India's GDP**
 - Save about **\$3 billion annually** in foreign exchange due to lower import duties.
- Total trade surplus with the US may cross **\$90 billion annually**.

Tariff Advantage & Competitiveness

- **Reciprocal tariff on Indian goods reduced to 18%**.
- Makes India **more competitive than key Asian exporters** like:
 - **Vietnam**
 - **ASEAN countries**
- Improves **price competitiveness** of Indian exports in the US market.

Export Growth Potential

- India's goods exports to the US may rise by **~\$100 billion annually**.
- Driven by:
 - **Tariff reductions**
 - Large **unmet demand** in the US market.
- US imports exceed **\$3 trillion**, while India's share is only **~3%** → huge growth scope.

Top Export Sectors Likely to Benefit

- **Electrical machinery**
- **Engineering goods**
- **Pharmaceuticals**
- **Vehicles**
- **Gems & jewellery**
- **Textiles**
- **Chemicals**
- **Seafood**
- Top 15 categories alone could add **~\$97 billion** in exports.

Agriculture Sector Gains

- **75% of India's agri exports** to the US to face **zero additional tariffs**.
- Key products benefiting:
 - **Rice**
 - **Spices**
 - **Tea & coffee**
 - **Oilseeds & nuts**
 - **Seafood**
- India already has an **agriculture trade surplus of ~\$1.3 billion** with the US.
- US imports:
 - **~25% of rice** from India.
- Expected boost to:
 - **Farmers**
 - **Fisheries**
 - **Plantation sectors**

Import Commitments by India

- India to **reduce/eliminate tariffs** on many US industrial & agricultural goods.
- Intention to import **\$500 billion worth of US products** over **5 years**, including:

- Energy
- Aircraft
- Technology products
- Precious metals
- Imports from US may rise by ~\$55 billion annually.
- Despite this, **trade balance remains in India's favour.**

China+1 Supply Chain Opportunity

- Agreement supports **China+1 diversification strategy.**
- Encourages **US companies to invest in India** for:
 - Value addition
 - Using India as a **global export base**
- Particularly strong opportunity in:
 - **Electronics**
 - **Electrical equipment**

Strategic & Economic Significance

- Strengthens India's role in **global supply chains.**
- Likely to:
 - Boost **manufacturing growth**
 - Increase **exports**
 - Improve **external balances**
- Marks a **major shift in India-US economic engagement.**

NATIONAL

PM Narendra Modi to inaugurate new PMO and Central Secretariat buildings

Major Inauguration

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi to inaugurate:
 - New **Prime Minister's Office (PMO)**
 - **Central Secretariat buildings**
 - **Kartavya Bhavan 1 & 2**
- Will also preside over the **last Union Cabinet meeting in South Block.**

End of an Era – North & South Block

- **North Block** and **South Block** to be vacated after decades of use.
- Originally housed the **British administration**; taken over by **Indian government in 1947.**
- Designed by **Herbert Baker.**

Existing Functions (Before Shift)

- **South Block:**
 - **Prime Minister's Office**
 - **Ministry of External Affairs**
 - **Ministry of Defence**
- **North Block:**
 - **Ministry of Home Affairs**
 - **Ministry of Finance**

'Seva Teerth' Complex – New Administrative Hub

- New **PMO** to shift to '**Seva Teerth**' complex.
- Will also house:
 - **National Security Council Secretariat**
 - **Cabinet Secretariat**
- These offices were earlier located at **different locations** → now consolidated.

Kartavya Bhavan 1 & 2 – Key Ministries Shifted

- Will accommodate major ministries, including:
 - **Finance**
 - **Defence**
 - **Health & Family Welfare**
 - **Education**
 - **Corporate Affairs**
 - **Culture**
 - **Law & Justice**
 - **Information & Broadcasting**
 - **Agriculture & Farmers Welfare**
 - **Chemicals & Fertilizers**
 - **Tribal Affairs**

Modern & Sustainable Infrastructure Features

- Buildings designed with:
 - **Digitally integrated offices**
 - **Structured public interface zones**
 - **Centralised reception systems**
- Built as per **4-Star GRIHA standards** (Green Rating for Integrated Habitat Assessment).
- Sustainability features include:
 - **Renewable energy systems**
 - **Water conservation measures**
 - **Waste management solutions**
 - **High-performance building design**

Significance for Governance

- Consolidation of **administrative functions** into **modern, future-ready facilities**.
- Aims to improve:
 - **Efficiency**
 - **Coordination**
 - **Accessibility**
 - **Public interface** in governance.

Chidambaranar Port Authority, Tuticorin Secures Platinum Rating for sustainable, eco-friendly buildings & Energy Efficiency Certification for energy-efficient, sustainable buildings

Major Achievement

- **V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority** becomes **India's first Major Port** to receive **IGBC Platinum Rating** (highest certification by **Indian Green Building Council**).
- Recognition for **sustainable infrastructure, energy efficiency, and green practices**.

Energy & Sustainability Features

- Administration Building operates on **100% renewable energy**:
 - **89%** electricity from **on-site solar panels**
 - **11%** from **off-site renewable sources**
- Equipped with:
 - **Rooftop solar panels**
 - **High Solar Reflectance Index (SRI) roof coating** → reduces **Urban Heat Island effect**
- Supports **energy conservation & decarbonisation goals**.

Water & Resource Efficiency

- Use of:
 - **IoT-enabled water meters**
 - **Rainwater harvesting systems**

- Water-saving plumbing fixtures
- Indoor Air Quality (IAQ) monitoring
- Achieved **37% reduction** in potable water usage.
- **100% wastewater treated & reused** through on-site **Sewage Treatment Plant (STP)**.

Green Campus Initiatives

- Campus has **70%+ green cover** through extensive tree plantation.
- **Seven IGBC Accredited Professionals** oversee sustainability implementation.

Health, Safety & Inclusivity Measures

- **No Smoking Policy** in the building.
- Use of **eco-friendly cleaning chemicals**.
- Accessibility features include:
 - **Non-slippery ramps**
 - **Differently-abled-friendly toilets**
 - **Electric wheelchairs**
 - **Lifts with braille & audio assistance**

BEE 'Shunya' & 'Shunya Plus' Certifications

- Awarded by **Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE)**, Ministry of Power.

Shunya Certification

- Indicates **Net Zero Energy Building**.
- Building produces **as much energy as it consumes annually**.
- **Energy Performance Index (EPI): 0–10 kWh/m²/year**.
- Awarded to:
 - **Administrative Building**
 - **Guest House**

Shunya Plus Certification

- Indicates **Net Positive Energy Building**.
- Produces **more energy than it consumes**.
- **EPI: Less than 0 kWh/m²/year**.
- Awarded to:
 - **Port Hospital**
 - **CISF Barracks**

Policy Alignment

- Initiatives aligned with:
 - **Maritime India Vision 2030**
 - **Harit Sagar – Green Port Guidelines**
- Supports **sustainable port infrastructure & inclusive growth**.

INTERNATIONAL

Tropical Cyclone Gezani hits Madagascar

Tropical Cyclone Gezani – Madagascar (2026)

Key Event Overview

- **Tropical Cyclone Gezani** struck **Madagascar** in February 2026.
- Hit the **port city of Toamasina** with winds exceeding **195 km/h**.
- Caused **major destruction, flooding, and landslides**.

Frequent Cyclone Vulnerability

- Madagascar is highly vulnerable to **cyclones from the Indian Ocean**.
- **Cyclone season: November–March**.
- Another cyclone (**Fytia**, Jan 2026):

- Since **2020**, the country has faced **12+ major storms/cyclones**.

Economic & Development Impact

- Annual cyclone damage estimated at **\$85 million** to infrastructure.
- Repeated disasters slow **development** in one of the **world's poorest nations**.
- Many residents live in **poverty with weak housing**, increasing risk.

Learn Along:

About Madagascar

Capital: Antananarivo

Currency: Ariary

India as Chair of the Kimberley Process 2026

Why in News?

- **India assumed Chairmanship** of the **Kimberley Process (KP)** for **2026**.
- Positions India at the **centre of global diamond governance**.
- Enhances India's role as a **Global South voice** in shaping reforms in the diamond value chain.

What is the Kimberley Process (KP)?

- **Initiated in 2000** by **Southern African countries**.
- Objective: **Regulate trade in rough diamonds** and prevent **conflict diamonds**.
- **Conflict diamonds**: Used by rebel groups to finance wars against legitimate governments.
- Not a **formal international organisation** or legally binding treaty.
- Operates through **national laws**, with support from:
 - Governments
 - Industry
 - Civil society

Participation

- **60 participants** representing **86 countries**.
- Covers **99.8% of global rough diamond production**.

Kimberley Process Certification Scheme (KPCS)

- Launched in **2003**.
- Requires:
 - Every shipment of rough diamonds to carry a **tamper-resistant KP certificate**.
 - Trade only between **certified member countries**.
 - Sharing of **accurate production & trade data** for transparency.
- **India is a founding member**.
- Enforcement done by **individual member countries**.

India's Diamond Industry

Diamond Resources

- Mining dates back to **5th century BCE**.
- Historic hubs:
 - **Golconda (Telangana)** – global trading centre in 16th–17th century.
- Early sources:
 - **Krishna, Mahanadi, Panna belts**.
- **Majhgawan Mine (Panna, MP)**:
 - India's **only operating commercial diamond mine**.
 - **Panna diamonds** have **GI Tag**.

Global Market Dominance

- India is a **major importer** of rough diamonds (from **UAE, Belgium, Russia**).
- **~90% of world's diamonds processed** in India.
- Accounts for **~75% of global diamond trade turnover (by value)**.
- Major centres:

- **Surat**
- **Mumbai**

Lab-Grown Diamonds (LGDs)

- India produced **3 million+ LGDs (2023)** → **15% of global output**.
- Manufactured using:
 - **CVD (Chemical Vapour Deposition)**
 - **HPHT (High Pressure High Temperature)**

Government Support

- **₹242 crore grant** (Union Budget FY24) for LGD research centre at **IIT Madras**.
- **Customs duty removed** on imported carbon seeds (Budget FY26).
- **100% FDI allowed** in LGD sector.
- Aim: Make India a **global manufacturing hub**, not just a polishing centre.

India's Strategic Role

- Major exporter of:
 - **Polished diamonds**
 - **Lab-grown diamonds**
- Key markets:
 - **USA**
 - **China**
 - **UAE**
 - **Hong Kong**
- Strong position in **global value chain** → influence global governance norms.

Challenges in Kimberley Process

- **Narrow definition** of conflict diamonds (only rebel-linked violence).
- **"Mixed origin" loophole** allows re-entry of conflict diamonds.
- **Consensus-based veto power** slows reforms.
- **No permanent secretariat** weakens monitoring.
- Applies only to **rough diamonds**, not polished ones.
- Rising popularity of **LGDs** may reduce demand for natural diamonds.

Reforms India Can Push as Chair

- **Expand definition** of conflict diamonds (include human rights concerns).
- Promote **blockchain-based certification** for traceability.
- Encourage **independent audits & transparency**.
- Support **African producer nations** through:
 - Technical hubs
 - Certification support
- Ensure diamond revenues benefit **local mining communities**.
- Align KP with **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**.

REPORTS AND INDEXES

Stanford University's 2025 Global AI Vibrancy Ranking

Global Rankings & Recognition

- India ranked **3rd** in **Stanford University's Global AI Vibrancy Ranking 2025** (after **USA & China**).
- **IMF AI Preparedness Index**: Score **49.3** (above **42.1** avg. of emerging economies).
- **Oxford Government AI Readiness Index 2025**:
 - **Rank: 27th globally**, leading **South & Central Asia**.
- India emerging as a **well-positioned AI-ready economy** globally.

AI Market Growth

- **Global AI market**:

- \$103.6B (2020) → \$288.8B (2024).
- **India's AI market:**
 - \$2.97B (2020) → \$7.63B (2024).
 - Expected to reach **\$131.31B by 2032** (CAGR 42.2%).
- AI becoming a **major driver of digital economy, investments & jobs.**

AI Skills, Adoption & Talent

- **AI skill penetration in India: 2.5× higher** than global average.
- **87% of enterprises** actively using **AI solutions** (NASSCOM Index).
- India leads in **AI talent hiring** with **~33% annual growth**.
- **19.9% global contribution to GitHub AI projects** (2nd largest in 2024).
- **2.62 lakh+ AI research papers** (2015–2025) → strong research base.

India's Strategic Edge

Demography

- **65%+ population under 35** → large tech-savvy workforce.
- Strong potential for **AI-driven innovation & digital jobs.**

Digital Infrastructure

- **Internet connections: 100+ crore** (up from 25 crore in 2014).
- **5G users: 400M+** → world's **2nd largest base.**
- **Optical fibre network: 42.36 lakh route km.**
- **2.14 lakh+ Gram Panchayats** connected with broadband.
- **National Data Centres** established in **Delhi, Pune, Bhubaneswar, Hyderabad.**
- **38,000 GPUs acquired (2024)** → boost for AI capacity.

Entrepreneurship

- **2 lakh+ DPIIT-recognised startups.**
- AI startups working on:
 - **Indian language models**
 - **Healthcare AI**
 - **Generative AI**
 - **Engineering simulations & analytics**

AI & Labour Market Transformation

- AI job postings in South Asia rose from **2.9% → 6.5%** (2023–2025).
- AI skill demand growing **75% faster** than non-AI roles.
- AI jobs offer:
 - **12% wage premium** for digital skills.
 - **28% premium** for AI-focused roles.
- New job roles emerging:
 - **Prompt engineers**
 - **AI trainers**
 - **Safety testers**
- Southern tech hubs leading:
 - **Bangalore (11%)**
 - **Hyderabad (9.57%)**
 - **Pune & Chennai**

Sectoral Impact

- **Services sector** (55.3% of GVA) rapidly integrating AI.
- AI boosting productivity in:
 - **IT**
 - **Finance**
 - **Healthcare**
 - **Education**
 - **Manufacturing & logistics**

- AI seen as **augmenting human work**, not replacing it.
- India's AI ecosystem already employs **6 million+ people**.

Productivity & Adoption

- **NASSCOM AI Index**: Score **2.45/4**.
- **88% organisations** using AI in at least one business function (McKinsey).
- **Generative AI productivity boost**:
 - **14% overall**
 - **34% for new/low-skilled workers**

Government Initiatives & Vision

National Program on AI (MeitY) – 4 Pillars

- **National Centre on AI**
- **Data Management Office**
- **Skilling in AI**
- **Responsible AI**

Key National Missions

- **Digital India**
- **Skill India**
- **FutureSkills Prime**
- **IndiaAI Mission (2024)**

BHASHINI Initiative

- AI-based platform supporting **36+ languages**.
- **1.2 million+ downloads** → breaking language barriers.

AI Economic Council (Proposed)

- To balance **AI adoption** with **human intelligence**.
- Align AI growth with **education & skilling infrastructure**.

Skill Development Initiatives

- **NEP 2020**: Focus on **AI literacy & computational thinking**.
- **SOAR Initiative**:
 - **1.34 lakh students & teachers enrolled**.
- **YUVAi (Youth for Unnati with AI)**:
 - AI exposure for **Classes 8–12**.
 - Focus areas: **Agriculture, Health, Education, Environment, Transport, Smart Cities, Law**.
- **YUVA AI for All**:
 - Aim: **Train 1 crore citizens** in AI skills.
 - Available in **11 languages**.
- **IndiaAI FutureSkills**:
 - Support for **500 PhDs, 5,000 PGs, 8,000 UG students**.
 - **27 AI labs** in Tier-2 & Tier-3 cities.
- **Skill India Digital Hub**:
 - Central platform for **AI & ML training**.

SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

Technology Services – Reimagination Ahead roadmap released by the NITI Aayog's Frontier Tech Hub

Major Announcement

- **NITI Aayog's Frontier Tech Hub** released a **10-year roadmap** titled **"Technology Services – Reimagination Ahead."**
- Focus: Transform India's **\$265 billion tech services sector** to **\$750–850 billion by 2035**.
- Linked to **AI-driven growth, global competitiveness, and Viksit Bharat 2047 vision**.

- Unveiled by **Commerce & Industry Minister Piyush Goyal** in presence of senior officials and industry leaders.

AI as a Structural Shift

- **Artificial Intelligence** seen as a **turning point** for the industry.
- Transition expected from:
 - **Labour-arbitrage services** → to **IP-led, platform-driven, outcome-based models**.
- Opportunity for India to move from **services leadership** to **global leadership** in **AI-native systems**.

Five Priority Growth Levers

- **Agentic AI**
- **Software & Product development**
- **Digital Infrastructure**
- **Innovation-led Engineering**
- **India-for-India solutions**

Key Policy & Industry Actions Suggested

- **Faster enterprise AI adoption**
- **Increased investment in IP and R&D**
- **Nationwide workforce reskilling**
- **Regulatory predictability** for global market access
- **Strong government–industry coordination**

Government Strategy & Reforms

- India pursuing a **full-stack AI strategy** covering:
 - **Energy**
 - **Infrastructure**
 - **Semiconductors**
 - **AI models & applications**
- Supporting reforms include:
 - **Higher safe-harbour thresholds**
 - **Simplified classifications**
 - **Cloud tax incentives** linked to Indian data centres
 - **Semiconductor Mission 2.0**
 - **Education-to-employment mechanisms**

Strategic Vision

- Aim to position India as a **trusted global leader** in **next-generation technology services**.
- AI seen as a **generational opportunity** to:
 - Create **new value pools**
 - **Upgrade skills** at scale
 - Generate **high-quality employment**
- Shift vision: From **“world’s back office”** to **“architect of AI-native enterprises.”**

About NITI Frontier Tech Hub

- Established as an **action-tank** for **Viksit Bharat**.
- Focus: Anticipate **emerging frontier technologies** and prepare India.
- Works with **100+ experts** from:
 - **Government**
 - **Industry**
 - **Academia**
- Developing **10-year roadmaps** across **20+ sectors** for:
 - **Economic growth**
 - **Inclusive development**
 - **Strategic resilience**

DEFENCE

DAC clears purchase of 114 Rafales for IAF, and six P-8I aircraft for Navy

Overall Highlights

- Defence Acquisition Council (DAC), chaired by Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, granted Acceptance of Necessity (AoN).
- Total capital acquisition proposals worth approx. **₹3.6 lakh crore** approved.
- One of the **largest defence procurement clearances** in recent years.
- Focus on **force modernisation, self-reliance, and combat capability enhancement**.

Indian Air Force (IAF) – Key Procurements

- AoN approved for **114 Multi-Role Fighter Aircraft (MRFA)** (Rafale jets from **France**).
- Additional approvals:
 - **Combat missiles**
 - **Air-Ship-Based High-Altitude Pseudo Satellite (AS-HAPS)**

Strategic Importance

- **Rafale jets** to strengthen:
 - **Air dominance capability**
 - **Long-range offensive power**
 - **Deterrence posture**
- **Majority of aircraft** to be **manufactured in India** → boost to **domestic defence production**.
- **Combat missiles** to enhance:
 - **Stand-off ground attack capability**
 - **Deep-strike precision**
- **AS-HAPS platform** to support:
 - **Intelligence, Surveillance & Reconnaissance (ISR)**
 - **Electronic Intelligence (ELINT)**
 - **Telecommunications & remote sensing**

Indian Army – Key Approvals

- Procurement of **Anti-tank mines (Vibhav)**.
- **Overhaul and upgrade** of existing platforms:
 - **Armoured Recovery Vehicles (ARVs)**
 - **T-72 tanks**
 - **BMP-II Infantry Combat Vehicles**

Strategic Importance

- **Vibhav mines** to act as **anti-tank obstacle systems** to:
 - **Delay & disrupt enemy mechanised forces**
- Upgradation to:
 - **Extend service life**
 - **Ensure operational readiness**

Indian Navy – Key Procurements

- Approval for **6 additional P-8I long-range maritime reconnaissance aircraft** from the **United States**.
- Procurement of **4 MW marine gas turbine-based electric power generator**.

Strategic Importance

- **P-8I aircraft** to strengthen:
 - **Anti-submarine warfare**
 - **Maritime surveillance**
 - **Maritime strike capability**
- Power generator under **Make-I category (DAP 2020)** to:
 - **Reduce dependence on foreign manufacturers**
 - **Promote self-reliance in naval systems**

Indian Coast Guard – Enhancement

- AoN granted for **Electro-Optical/Infrared (EO/IR)** systems for **Dornier** aircraft.
- Will improve:
 - **Maritime surveillance**
 - **Coastal security operations**

MoD inks Rs 2,312 crore contract with HAL for eight Dornier 228 Aircraft under Buy (Indian) category

Key Contract Details

- **Ministry of Defence** signed a contract with **Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)**, Transport Aircraft Division, Kanpur.
- Procurement of **8 Dornier 228 Aircraft** with **Operational Role Equipment** for the **Indian Coast Guard (ICG)**.
- Total cost: **₹2,312 crore**.
- Category: **Buy (Indian)**.
- Contract signed on **February 12, 2026**, in presence of **Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh**.

Strategic Importance

- Strengthens **maritime security architecture** of India.
- Enhances **surveillance, patrol, and coastal security capabilities** of the **Indian Coast Guard**.
- Supports **indigenous defence production**.

Boost to Self-Reliance

- Reinforces **Aatmanirbhar Bharat** and **Make in India** initiatives.
- Promotes **domestic manufacturing** in the defence sector.

Economic & Employment Impact

- Expected to generate **significant direct and indirect employment**.
- Strengthens **HAL's production ecosystem**.
- Supports a wide network of:
 - **MSMEs**
 - **Ancillary industries**

Long-Term Industrial Benefits

- Creates sustained opportunities in:
 - **Maintenance, Repair & Overhaul (MRO)**
 - **Life-cycle technical support**
- Contributes to long-term **capacity building** in the aviation and defence sector.

EVENTS

Bodhan Alat conclave

Policy Vision

- **Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan** emphasised that **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** must be integrated into **education**.
- Objective:
 - **Empower students**
 - **Support teachers**
 - Improve overall **learning outcomes**

Bharat Bodhan AI Conclave – Major Announcement

- Launch of **Bodhan AI** at the inaugural session of the **Bharat Bodhan AI Conclave**.

- Established as a **non-profit organisation** under the **Ministry of Education**.

Bharat EduAI Stack – Key Initiative

- Bodhan AI** will develop an **open-source “Bharat EduAI Stack”**.
- Aim:
 - Introduce **AI across all levels of education**
 - Build it as a **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)** for the education sector.

Role of IIT Madras

- Mitesh Khapra (IIT Madras)** unveiled **Bodhan AI**.
- Presented roadmap for **Bharat EduAI Stack** as a **technology backbone** for AI-based learning.

Expected Impact on Education

- According to **IIT Director V. Kamakoti**, the initiative will help make education:
 - Equitable**
 - High-quality**
 - Affordable**
 - Easily accessible**

IMPORTANT DAYS

Day/Week	Observance	Significance
February 13	World Radio Day	World Radio Day, observed annually on February 13 commemorates the establishment of United Nations Radio in 1946. The theme of World Radio Day 2026 is “Radio and Artificial Intelligence: AI is a tool, not a voice.” The first Community Radio Station was inaugurated on February 1, 2004 by Bharat Ratna Shri Lal Krishna Advani. Ram Singh Bouddh from Amroha, Uttar Pradesh, known as the “Radio Man of India,” was recognised by Guinness World Records in 2025 for owning the world’s largest collection of 1,257 radios.

Answer key to Memory check

Q:1- B Q:2- C Q:3- C Q:4- C Q:5- C

Sources of the News:

The Hindu, The Indian Express, Business Standard, The Financial Express, PIB, etc.